

The 6:15

SATURDAY · SEPTEMBER 19, 2026

NO. 16

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (WEEKEND EDITION — CONDENSED)

Today

Northwestern (1-0) hosts Colorado (2-0), 7:30p ET/6:30p CT, favored by 3.5, O/U 48.5 — last game at Martin Stadium before the Ryan Field move. FOMC's next meeting is now confirmed for Oct. 27-28 (rate decision 2p ET Oct. 28; non-SEP, no fresh dot plot) **[NEW]**, resolving issue No. 15's unconfirmed date.

Wk of 9/22

Durable goods, final Q2 GDP, existing home sales, initial claims (~9/25), and PCE (~9/26) — dates carried from a single weekly preview in issue No. 15, not cross-checked against BLS/BEA calendars **[dates indicative, not confirmed]**. No verified rocket-launch, AI-model, or VC-funding item from the prior 24-48h located this run; sub-bullet skipped.

Politics, Economics, Business, and Technology carry nothing new verified this run and are cut for this weekend edition — see Continuity.

METRICS (WEEKEND EDITION — CONDENSED) · AS OF FRI 9/18 CLOSE UNLESS NOTED

Oil/rates/vol

Brent \$103.87 (-0.9%); WTI \$100.30 (-1.6%); a separate generic crude quote showed \$99.53/-2.3% **[not reconciled]**; 10Y ~4.94% (roughly flat vs. Thu); DXY 99.98 (flat on the day, slipping back under 100 after Thursday's one-session reclaim); VIX 14.81, down from Thursday's 17.71 close — the exact one-day % move couldn't be reconciled across sources checked this run **[flag]**; gold \$4,415.90 (+0.4%, fresh high).

Equities/other

Dow 51,682.64 (-0.18%); S&P 500 7,650.50 (+0.17%); Nasdaq Comp. 26,522.55 (+0.39%); Nikkei 65,018.95 (+1.4%, Fri Tokyo close); FTSE 100 10,730.39 (-0.8%); retail gas \$4.4687/gal natl. avg (AAA, Fri 9/18), +3¢ on the week; 2Y and 30Y not confirmed as of press time **[unverified]**.

Crude: ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month. Rates: Fed H.15/CME. Equities: exchange closes/CNBC/Bloomberg.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Strikes (48h)

Two new incidents reported Friday: UKMTO said a tanker was hit by an unidentified projectile while exiting the strait Wednesday night, perpetrator unconfirmed, crew safe; separately Iran's IRGC claimed it struck the Togo-flagged tanker *Trend* Thursday night for an "illegal" unauthorized-transit attempt — AP could not independently verify. No verified running strike total exists this run **[NEW/gap]**.

IRGC posture

The Guard's navy warned, per Iranian state broadcaster reporting, that vessels attempting passage "without authorization" would face "destruction" — blunter than the "illegal crossing" language used around the disputed Sept. 13 Qeshm incident. **[NEW]**

Transits

Kpler's Sept. 16 figures — the same unreconciled 12-vessel vs. 3-vessel split flagged in issue No. 15 — not refreshed this run **[gap, aging]**.

Dark tankers/AIS

straits.live's stranded-vessel series not refreshed since issue No. 14's 490 total **[gap, aging]**.

War-risk premia

Insurance Day/Lloyd's List still frame Gulf transits at 3-10% of hull value (~\$21M high end on a \$210M VLCC), the same range issue No. 15 reported — no fresher print located this run.

Kpler's AIS averages, Lloyd's List's weekly aggregation, straits.live's snapshots, and the hull-value-percentage premia figures above all measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees

Played at Arizona Fri. 9/18; box-score reports diverged across sources checked this run and the final score could not be reconciled **[not confirmed as of press time]**. Holding the AL's top wild-card spot on a clinched playoff berth (since Mon. 9/14); record as of Thursday 88-64.

Knicks

No reported moves in the last 24 hours; Towns/Hart contract situation unchanged from issue No. 15.

Northwestern

Hosts Colorado tonight — see Calendar.

Vol collapses and oil keeps falling through a weekend that opened with two new Hormuz tanker strikes and an explicit Iranian "destruction" threat

Friday's close read like a market pricing the Gulf conflict as background noise rather than an active war. The VIX settled at 14.81, down sharply from Thursday's already-elevated 17.71 — though the exact one-day percentage move couldn't be reconciled between sources checked this run, since one shows just -4.1% (-0.63pts), a figure that doesn't chain cleanly back to Thursday's level. [flag] The S&P 500 added 0.17% to 7,650.50 and the Nasdaq Composite gained 0.39% to 26,522.55, while the Dow slipped 0.18% to 51,682.64 — a shrug, not a selloff, in the same week the Fed delivered its first hike since 2023. [fact] Brent fell a further 0.9% to \$103.87 and WTI eased 1.6% to \$100.30 (a separate generic crude quote showed \$99.53, down 2.3% — not reconciled), extending a slide that is now running in parallel with, not in response to, a harder Iranian posture inside the strait. [fact/flag]

That posture hardened overnight. UKMTO reported a tanker hit by an unidentified projectile while exiting the strait Wednesday night, and Iran's Revolutionary Guard separately claimed Thursday night to have struck the Togo-flagged tanker *Trend* for an unauthorized transit attempt — a claim the AP could not independently verify. [NEW] The Guard's navy went further in state-broadcaster reporting, warning that any vessel attempting passage "without authorization" would face "destruction," blunter language than the "illegal crossing" framing used around the disputed Sept. 13 Qeshm incident

issue No. 15 covered. [NEW/quote] None of it moved Friday's oil tape. [read]

The mechanism is the one flagged in issue No. 15: crude futures are tracking reported Saudi and Omani workaround supply more than the security situation inside the strait itself, and this run can't test that read against fresher flow data — Kpler's transit counts are still stuck on the unreconciled Sept. 16 split (12 vessels vs. three, depending on source) carried over unchanged. [flag] What's new is that the market's other stress gauges are leaning the same direction as oil: gold hit a fresh high Friday at \$4,415.90 (+0.4%) even as the dollar's one-session reclaim of the 100 level didn't hold — DXY slipped back to 99.98, essentially flat on the day — and the 10-year sat around 4.94%, roughly where it closed Thursday. [fact/read] Risk assets up, vol down, oil down, gold up, rates flat: that combination looks less like a coherent read on any single catalyst than a broad de-risking into quarter-end. [read]

The FOMC's next meeting is now confirmed for Oct. 27-28, a decision due 2 p.m. ET on the 28th; it's a non-SEP meeting, so no fresh dot plot accompanies it. [NEW] That gives the Committee five weeks to watch whether the supply-workaround story holds or whether one of this week's two new tanker incidents escalates into something that reprices the complex at once — the same "one meeting behind" risk flagged twice now, still unresolved either way. [continuity/read] For positioning: a VIX in the 14s heading into a live war in the world's most important chokepoint is cheap optionality by the numbers alone. Whether that's opportunity or mispricing depends on which of Friday's two data points — the tanker attacks or the equity tape — turns out to be the noise. [read]

GEOPOLITICS

Russian guided bombs killed two municipal workers and injured eight, including a 13-year-old, in a nine-story residential building in Sumy Friday, among strikes that also hit Kyiv, Zaporizhzhia, and Odesa regions this week. [fact, single-sourced this run] Ukraine struck back at an oil refinery in Yaroslavl, northeast of Moscow, and hit warplanes and helicopters at a base near Rostov, per President Zelensky. [fact/quote] Separately, a bipartisan sanctions bill targeting Russian energy revenue has reached President Trump's desk, per Sen. Jeanne Shaheen, who warned Putin is betting he can outlast Western support before the bill bites. [fact/quote, single-sourced] No corroboration of the bill's specific provisions or a signing timeline was located this run. [flag]

IRAN & HORMUZ

The Salalah meeting between Gulf foreign ministers and Iran, already reported postponed indefinitely in issue No. 15, drew a fuller account this week: Iranian officials say Saudi Arabia requested the postponement, while Oman's Badr Albusaidi called it a mutual, consensus-preserving decision — accounts that assign the driving role to different parties. [DEVELOPING] No new date has been set. [fact] The two fresh tanker incidents over Wednesday and Thursday nights (see Hormuz counters) arrived alongside the IRGC's bluntest threat yet — "destruction" for unauthorized transits — a rhetorical escalation that Friday's oil tape didn't move on (see Lead). [NEW] The strait has remained under partial Iranian closure since the US-Israel air war began Feb. 28; that baseline hasn't shifted in either direction this run. [continuity]

SPORTS

Yankees	At Arizona Fri. 9/18; final score not confirmed as of press time. Clinched AL playoff berth (9/14); top AL wild card, 88-64 through Thu.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours; Towns/Hart situation unchanged.
Northwestern	Hosts Colorado (2-0) tonight, 7:30p ET, favored by 3.5, O/U 48.5 — result next issue.

Weekend edition. Per standing rules, Calendar and Metrics run condensed and Politics, Economics, Business, and Technology are cut — nothing verified this run moved in any of those beyond what issue No. 15 already carried.

Continuity. Not refreshed this run: Kpler's Sept. 16 transit counts; straits.live's dark-tanker tally; FedEx's Q1 FY27 print (flagged pending in issue No. 15, still not verified via Nasdaq/CNBC this run); the Nvidia-Hugging Face deal, Amazon FTC ad-auction suit, Ford/CATL battery scrutiny, Anthropic IPO timeline, Starship's next date, and the OpenAI-Anthropic Navier-Stokes dispute (no new development located). Watch for next issue: Friday's confirmed Yankees score; the Northwestern-Colorado result; any Salalah reschedule date; corroboration of the Russia sanctions bill's provisions; whether Friday's vol/oil complacency holds through a full week.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.